

Your Dog Has Demodex

A guide for your dog's recovery at home

Your dog was diagnosed with demodex (demodectic mange) while in our care at the shelter. Refer to your adoption paperwork for your dog's specific diagnosis and any medications already started.

What to Expect

- Demodex is a microscopic mite that lives naturally in small numbers in the hair follicles of most dogs. It is not contagious to people or other healthy adult dogs.
- **Localized** demodex is a few small patches, usually on the face or legs, and often resolves with minimal treatment.
- **Generalized** demodex is widespread and requires active treatment over several months, with rechecks to confirm the mites have cleared.

Home Care

- Give oral medication (such as Bravecto) exactly as directed — it remains active for about 3 months.
- Keep the skin clean; avoid harsh shampoos not recommended by your veterinarian.
- Feed a high-quality diet and minimize stress to support your dog's immune system.
- Do not give additional flea, tick, or parasite products without checking with your veterinarian first.

Contact Your Veterinarian If Your Dog Has:

- Hair loss spreading to new areas or patches getting larger
- Increased redness, swelling, crusting, or odor from the skin
- Pustules, sores, or oozing — may indicate a secondary infection
- No improvement after several weeks of treatment

Follow-Up Care

Schedule a follow-up visit with your veterinarian within **3–4 weeks** after adoption to recheck progress and continue treatment as needed.

Do not stop treatment without veterinary guidance.